Carpool Coordination App — MVP Spec

Date: Date TBD
Status: Draft — generated from meeting extraction

1. Overview

The Carpool Coordination App is designed to facilitate efficient ride-sharing for individuals attending training sessions. It addresses the inefficiencies and mental overhead associated with manually organizing carpools through group chats, offering a streamlined and user-friendly solution to optimize the process of finding and offering rides.

2. Target Users

Drivers

- **Needs:** Simplified process for offering rides; a clear system to announce and manage available seats.
- **Usage:** To efficiently offer rides without navigating complex communication systems.

Passengers

- **Needs:** Easy access to available carpools; clarity on pickup logistics.
- **Usage:** To conveniently find rides and choose between carpooling and public transport.

Public Transport Users

- **Needs:** Option to carpool for convenience or during public transport disruptions.
- **Usage:** As an alternative to enhance flexibility and comfort.

3. Problem Statement

Current carpool arrangements using group chats are inefficient, requiring significant effort from both drivers and passengers. The manual systems lead to poor route optimization, communication overload, and uncertainty in travel logistics. The MVP will streamline this process, reducing complexity and enhancing clarity for all users.

4. Goals & Success Criteria

- **Efficiency:** Reduce the time spent coordinating rides in group messages.
- **Adoption:** Achieve high user participation in carpools based on app simplicity.

- **Clarity:** Ensure clear communication of pickup locations and availability.

5. MVP Feature Set

- **Driver Availability Input** — Drivers can indicate their availability and number of seats.
  - *Detail:* Input system for drivers to announce rides; viewable by passengers.
  - *Priority:* Core
- **Passenger Ride Request** — Passengers can indicate if they need a ride.
  - *Detail:* Option for passengers to request a carpool or indicate use of public transport.
  - *Priority:* Core
- **Visual Availability List** — Interface to display drivers and available seats.
  - *Detail:* Display a list of drivers with seat availability for easy reference.
  - *Priority:* Core
- **Travel Impact Estimation** — Show drivers potential time impacts of pickups.
  - *Detail:* Estimate added travel time for each passenger pickup.
  - *Priority:* Important

6. User Flows

Driver Flow

1. Input availability and number of seats.
2. View list of passengers requesting rides.

Passenger Flow

1. Browse available rides.
2. Indicate if needing a ride or opting for public transport.

7. Out of Scope (Post-MVP)

- **Advanced Route Optimization** — Complex algorithms for fully optimized routing.
- **Attendance Tracking Features** — More sophisticated attendance and data management.

8. Technical Considerations

- Manual travel time input may be needed for time impact estimation.
- Initial prototype planned on Discord to test functionality.

9. Assumptions & Risks

Assumptions: - Users will value a more efficient coordination system. - Drivers require minimal encouragement to use the app.

Risks & blockers: - User reluctance to adopt new systems without incentives. - Complexity in balancing ease of use with feature richness.

10. Competitive & Market Context

- Current comparison is to manual coordination using group chats, which is inefficient.

11. Open Questions

- Effective strategies to incentivize driver participation.
- Design of an onboarding process to streamline user adoption.

12. Next Steps

- Develop a basic version of the app on Discord for prototype testing (Owner: Product Manager).

This spec was synthesized from a meeting extraction and may contain gaps. Review with all participants before treating as final.